oyster

Oyster is software that configures and quotes enterprise hardware for IT resellers

A year learning to capture a vendor's rules on IBM. HPE took weeks. The first external user had a file in HPE's configurator **19 minutes** after signing up. Raising **12 MSEK** seed.

Axel Sundelöf · axel.sundelof@oyster.tech · October 2026

Confidential

TRACTION

Forty users in four weeks, and the first one had a file in HPE's configurator nineteen minutes after signing up

40

Users signed up or onboarding since the doors opened on 29 September, five countries

19 min

First external user: signup to a configuration loaded in HPE OCA

99 %

Pass the vendor's configurator first time

100+

Presales engineers at some 60 HPE resellers in 12 countries approached

25

Production releases in October, each from something a user hit

2

Vendors live, IBM and HPE. Zero outside capital so far

PROBLEM

Every vendor ships its own configurator, and only the one architect who knows it can drive it

- **HPE OCA, IBM eConfig:** an hour or two of clicking per server
- A solution architect covers **one to two vendors**
- A reseller carries **five**
- Deals outside those vendors are **turned away**
- An architect costs **90 to 130k SEK a month**

2 hours
per configuration today

5 minutes
with Oyster

> "This is the future of the field. AI assist means one engineer covers roughly five vendors."
>
> Marius Midtskogen, principal IBM Solution Architect at a Nordic distributor and our pilot user

PRODUCT

Describe the deal. The file loads in the vendor's configurator.

1 · The brief, verbatim

"A cheap server with two power supplies. iLO. Two NICs. 16 GB RAM. Windows Server 2025 Standard."

A reseller engineer's first request, 15 October. Oyster asked four questions back.

2 · Oyster builds

DL320 Gen12, Xeon 6507P, memory, two 960 GB SSDs, boot kit, four-port 1GbE, two PSUs, licence, support

25 lines, every one checked against HPE's own rules. 19 minutes from signup.

3 · The verdict

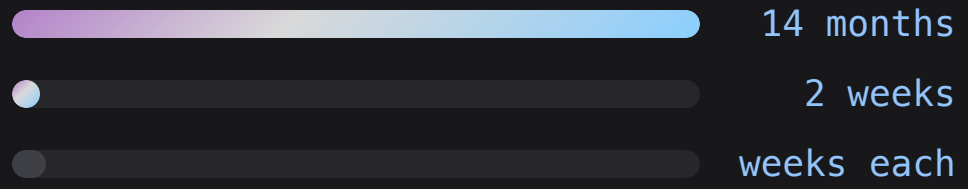
Loaded in HPE OCA

Twelve September test briefs through OCA: nine accepted with an HPE order reference, two correctly refused as unbuildable, one duplicate.

Vendor order file, bill of materials, branded quote. **Works in the browser, or inside Claude and ChatGPT.**

MOAT

The rules are not in the model



CAPTURED CATALOGUES

135 HPE chassis, 110,000 option codes, nine IBM Power machine types, read from the vendors' own tools, not from documents.

VERIFIED RULES

4,800 vendor rules, each proven in the vendor's configurator before it ships. A rule without a proof never reaches production.

EVERY DEAL ADDS RULES

Built with practising solution architects, deal by deal. **25 releases in October** came from gaps users found.

When the next model ships, nothing changes: **the model picks options, code copies part numbers from the captured catalogue.**

WHY NOW

Three things changed in 2026

CHANNEL

IBM and HPE cut to two distributors each. Resellers lose their presales desk.

TECHNOLOGY

Capturing a vendor catalog went from years to weeks.

CATEGORY

US resellers already pay 49k USD a year for a bespoke version.

BUSINESS MODEL

Per build is the entry. Capture a vendor once, sell it to every reseller carrying that line.

50 SEK / build

A presales engineer spends 170 to 345 SEK of time on the same server

10 SEK / rebuild

Design change on the same chassis, up to three times

~90 %

Gross margin on a build; 30% on the conversation tokens

25 %

To the distributor that co-sells

Sign up, two builds free, then card top-ups from 100 SEK. An engineer building two a day pays about **2,000 SEK a month**, a seat price a buyer recognises. No procurement cycle: one engineer starts today. The deal layer on the next slide is where the revenue per reseller grows.

WHERE THIS GOES

The deal in the channel has no system of record. We hold the hardest piece.

Now · The configuration

A build that passes the vendor's own validator

50 SEK a build, about 2,000 SEK a month per active engineer. 100,000 presales engineers in Europe and the US.

LIVE

→

Next · The deal file

Requote when a part goes end-of-life. Switch a competitor's BOM to the lines you carry. Quote and order in one place.

Priced per reseller, not per build. The request, the configuration, the quote and the renewal in one record, three years long.

BUILT ON WHAT IS LIVE

→

Then · The channel

A share of the hardware that flows through, distributors first

Our pilot distributor moves 1.9 bn SEK a year. One percent of that is 19 MSEK, from one of several hundred distributors in Europe.

THE BUSINESS

Every step uses the same machinery: captured catalogues and verified rules. **The configuration is the wedge; the deal file is the product; the channel is the market.**

Engineer counts: Europe our estimate from headcount and channel benchmarks; US from BLS, 51,600 sales engineers in 2025.

DISTRIBUTION

A Nordic distributor runs the pilot. A three-year contract is in negotiation, to sign before year end.

IN NEGOTIATION · THREE YEARS · TARGET: SIGNED BY YEAR END

Catalogue	300,000 SEK
Monthly minimum, years 1 to 3	40k → 60k → 80k SEK
Unit	50 SEK per build
Co-selling	25% to the distributor
Proposed value	2.5 MSEK

The distributor

Nordic, 1.9 bn SEK, nine countries. Co-built the IBM line with us since June.

→

400 resellers

Already buy from the distributor. Pay per build, about 2,000 SEK a month per active engineer.

Non-exclusive.

COMPETITION

Nobody validates configurations across vendors, and the catalogue alone does not get you there

WHO	WHAT THEY HAVE	WHAT THEY LACK
Vendor configurators	Authoritative, single-vendor	A specialist to drive them. Never validate a competitor's line
General CPQ	Pricing and quoting for anything	Hardware rules. Will quote a drawer the chassis cannot power
Bespoke AI builds, US	One reseller, one catalogue, 49k USD a year	Multi-vendor. Every new customer is a rebuild
Distributor presales desks	Specialists working in the vendor tools by hand	Bandwidth. No tooling of their own, and being cut as vendors consolidate

Our rules come from practising solution architects, captured deal by deal. **The catalogue is the raw material; the expertise is the product.**

TEAM

Ten years selling this hardware, ten years shipping products, fifteen years building systems

FOUNDER · SALES, ARCHITECTURE

Axel Sundelöf

Runs Object First's Nordic organisation today: **zero to 1 MUSD a quarter with a five-person team**. Before that, data centre sales and solution architecture at HPE and NetApp. Sells Oyster.

FOUNDER · PRODUCT

Christoffer Jensen

Most recently CPO at a gaming company; before that eight years of product for **Scania, H&M, Försäkringskassan, MediCarrier and Carium**.

FOUNDER · ENGINEERING

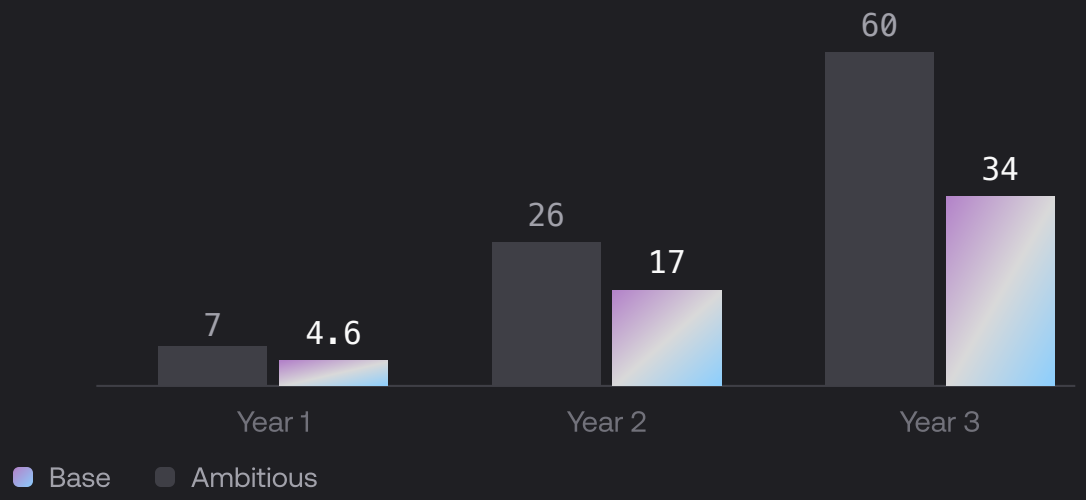
Isak Burström

Fifteen years full-stack, runs his own development agency, AI integration and system architecture. Owns the rules engine and the validation.

THE ASK

12 MSEK funds 24 months to break-even

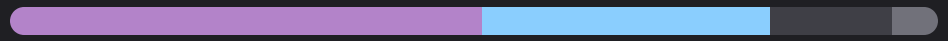
EXIT ARR, MSEK



WHAT THE ROUND FUNDS

- **Three founders full time** from the first month of the round
- **Distributor contract signed** and selling, by year end
- **Two more vendors live**, weeks each on the HPE machinery
- **1,000 active engineers**, 24 MSEK ARR: break-even Y3 Q2, no second round in the base case

USE OF FUNDS, 24 MONTHS



Hires 51% · Founders 31% · Overhead 13% · Inference 5%

Vertical SaaS sold at 7 to 8.5 times revenue in 2025. At 5 to 8 times: **170 to 270 MSEK** base, 300 to 480 ambitious.

Looking for a lead.